

USER MANUAL · VERSION 01

Claude SEO Pro

The complete, step-by-step guide to running enterprise-grade, evidence-verified SEO from a single command line — for the SEO manager, not the engineer.

Audience: the in-house SEO manager / consultant operating the system day to day

Covers: onboarding, every command, the full-audit pipeline, keyword research, local/GBP, reading reports, security, troubleshooting

Version: v01 | **Applies to:** Claude SEO Pro 1.0.0

Note: this manual covers *using the system*. Installing the repository from GitHub is covered separately in the project README.

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1. What Claude SEO Pro is

Claude SEO Pro is an SEO analysis system that runs **inside Claude Code** (the terminal AI assistant). You type plain commands like `/seo audit https://yourclient.com` and it produces a prioritised, evidence-backed SEO report — the kind of work that normally takes a senior consultant hours, in minutes.

It is built for **one SEO manager to do the work of a team**: full technical audits, content & E-E-A-T review, schema, Core Web Vitals, AI-search readiness, keyword research, local/GBP, and competitor analysis — all from one place, with the data living on your own machine.

What makes the "Pro" version different

- **Guided onboarding** — a wizard walks you through connecting your data APIs securely (covered in sections 4–6).
- **A smarter full-audit pipeline** — it understands the *business* first, then audits, then researches keywords, then checks local presence (section 8).
- **An anti-fabrication guarantee** — it will never invent a number. If it can't verify something, it tells you (section 2).

You don't need to be technical. If you can type a command and read a report, you can run this. This manual assumes no coding knowledge. Where a command is shown, you copy it exactly.

2. How it thinks: skills, agents & the no-fabrication rule

Three ideas explain everything the system does. Understanding them takes two minutes and makes the rest obvious.

Skills = the commands you type

A "skill" is a capability you trigger with a slash command. `/seo audit`, `/seo schema`, `/seo-setup` are all skills. You'll see the full list in section 7.

Agents = the specialists it sends out

When you run a big job like a full audit, the system dispatches several **specialist agents** in parallel — one for technical SEO, one for content, one for schema, and so on. Each examines the site and reports back. You don't manage them; they work behind the scenes. It's why a full audit is both fast and thorough.

The no-fabrication rule (the "Evidence Integrity Protocol")

This is the most important thing to trust. The system is built so that **every finding traces back to real evidence** — a line in the site's code, or a field in a real API response. If a page can't be fetched, or an API isn't connected, it writes **"Data pending"** rather than guessing.

Why this matters to you. An SEO report you hand a client is only as good as your credibility. This system is designed so you never present a number that later turns out to be invented. When it says a section is "pending", that's a feature — it's protecting you.

Where the data comes from

Two kinds: **on-site** (the system reads the website's own pages and code — always available, no account needed) and **off-site** (rankings, keyword volumes, backlinks, Google Business Profile — these need an API account you connect during onboarding).

3. Before you start: what you need

REQUIREMENT	WHY	REQUIRED?
Claude Code (installed & signed in)	The environment Claude SEO Pro runs in	REQUIRED
Python 3.10+	Runs the onboarding wizard and helper scripts	REQUIRED
Node.js	Runs the data connectors (DataForSEO, Firecrawl, Exa)	FOR OFF-SITE DATA
A DataForSEO account	Rankings, keyword research, local data, competitors	STRONGLY RECOMMENDED
A Google API key	Real Core Web Vitals (speed) field data	RECOMMENDED
Google Search Console / GA4 access	Indexation + traffic data	OPTIONAL
Google Business Profile access	First-party local insights (owner only)	OPTIONAL

The system **works with none of the optional items** — it will still do a complete on-site audit. Each API you connect simply unlocks more of the off-site picture. Start with what you have; add the rest later (section 6).

How do I know it's installed?

Open Claude Code in a terminal by typing `claude`. Then type `/seo` — if the system offers SEO commands, you're ready. If not, the repository hasn't been installed yet; see the project README for the one-time install, then return [here](#).

4. First launch & the /seo-setup wizard

Your very first task is connecting your data sources. There are two equivalent ways; pick whichever feels comfortable.

Option A — let Claude guide you (recommended)

- 1 Start Claude Code: type `claude` and press `Enter`.
- 2 Type `/seo-setup` and press `Enter`.
- 3 Claude explains each data provider, what it unlocks, and where to get the key, then walks you through connecting them. Follow along conversationally.

Option B — run the wizard directly in your terminal

Inside Claude Code you can run a terminal command by starting the line with `!`. Run:

```
! python ~/.claude/skills/seo/onboarding/setup_wizard.py
```

The wizard prints a menu, asks for each key, checks it against the live service, and stores it securely. Both options do the same thing.

Golden rule — never paste an API key into the chat. Keys are secrets. The wizard hides them as you type (you won't see the characters — that's normal). If you ever accidentally paste a key into the conversation, treat it as exposed and regenerate it from the provider's dashboard.

What "connecting a provider" actually does

1. You paste the key into the wizard's **hidden** prompt (in your terminal, not the chat).
2. The wizard **validates** it live — so a typo is caught immediately, not three audits later.
3. It **stores** the key in a protected folder on your computer (see section 14).
4. For data connectors, it **wires up** the connection so Claude can use it automatically.

After connecting anything, **restart Claude Code** so it loads the new connections. Then type `/seo-setup verify` to confirm everything is green.

5. Connecting your APIs (one by one)

Here is each provider, what it unlocks, and exactly where to get the credential. Connect the ones you need; skip the rest.

DataForSEO **MOST VALUABLE**

Unlocks: keyword rankings, the full keyword-research suite, competitor analysis, business listings, and AI-mention tracking — the engine behind most off-site data.

Get it: register at app.dataforseo.com/register. In the dashboard, find your **API password** (this is different from your login password) under API Access. You'll enter your login email + that API password.

The #1 gotcha — IP whitelist. DataForSEO can be set to only accept calls from approved IP addresses. If your data calls fail with error `40207`, your computer's internet (IP) address isn't on the approved list. Fix it at app.dataforseo.com/api-access — either add the IP it shows you, or **turn the whitelist off**. If you're on home/mobile internet your IP changes often, so turning the whitelist off is usually simplest.

Google API key **RECOMMENDED**

Unlocks: real Core Web Vitals "field data" (how fast the site actually is for real visitors) and PageSpeed.

Get it: at console.cloud.google.com/apis/credentials, create an API key. Then **enable** two APIs on that key's project: "PageSpeed Insights API" and "Chrome UX Report API".

Google Search Console + GA4 **OPTIONAL · SKIPPABLE**

Unlocks: indexation status, search performance (clicks, impressions, average position), and organic traffic from Analytics.

Get it: this one uses a sign-in flow (OAuth), not a simple key. In Google Cloud, create an "OAuth client → Desktop app" and download its `client_secret.json`. The wizard records it and gives you a one-time sign-in command to run. Make sure the Google account you sign in with has access to the Search Console property and the GA4 property.

Don't have access yet? Choose **"attach later"** in the wizard (section 6). The audit still runs — these sections just show "Data pending" until you connect them.

Google Business Profile **OPTIONAL · OWNER ONLY**

Unlocks: first-party local insights — real impressions, calls, direction requests, and posts from the business's Google listing.

Get it: also a sign-in flow, requiring the **"Google Business Profile API"** enabled and the signed-in account to have **owner/manager access** to the business listing.

No owner access? No problem. Skip it. The local audit automatically falls back to DataForSEO's public Google-Business data, so you still get a full Local SEO section — just without the owner-only metrics.

Firecrawl & Exa **OPTIONAL**

Firecrawl (`firecrawl.dev/app/api-keys`) handles crawling very large or JavaScript-heavy sites. **Exa** (`dashboard.exa.ai/api-keys`) adds neural web search for competitor and entity research. Both are simple API keys.

6. "Attach later" & checking status

Connecting things when you're ready

You rarely have every credential on day one. The sign-in providers (Search Console/GA4 and Business Profile) let you choose, in the wizard:

CHOICE	WHAT HAPPENS
[N]ow	Connect it immediately, including the one-time sign-in.
[L]ater	Mark it "pending". The audit runs without it and clearly labels the missing sections. Connect it whenever you're ready.
[S]kip	Don't use this provider at all for now.

Connecting (or replacing) just one provider

```
# add or re-do a single provider (e.g. dataforseo, exa, gbp)
! python ~/.claude/skills/seo/onboarding/setup_wizard.py --provider dataforseo
```

Checking what's connected

Any time, run a status check:

```
! python ~/.claude/skills/seo/onboarding/setup_wizard.py --check
```

You'll see each provider marked **connected**, **pending (attach later)**, or **not configured** — plus whether your stored keys have safe file permissions. Inside Claude you can also just say `/seo-setup verify` and Claude reads this for you.

A "pending" provider is a reminder, not an error. The system is telling you exactly what's left to unlock — and the audit will keep working in the meantime.

7. The command reference

Everything is a `/seo` command. Here are the ones you'll actually use, grouped by job. Pass a website URL where shown.

SETUP & THE BIG ONE

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/seo-setup</code>	Connect your APIs (the onboarding wizard)
<code>/seo-setup verify</code>	Show what's connected / pending
<code>/seo audit <url></code>	Full site audit — the 4-phase pipeline (section 8)

FOCUSED ANALYSES

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/seo page <url></code>	Deep analysis of one page
<code>/seo technical <url></code>	Crawlability, indexing, security, mobile, speed
<code>/seo content <url></code>	Content quality & E-E-A-T (expertise/trust)
<code>/seo schema <url></code>	Structured data: detect, validate, generate
<code>/seo geo <url></code>	AI-search readiness (AI Overviews, ChatGPT, Perplexity)
<code>/seo images <url></code>	Image SEO: alt text, size, format
<code>/seo sitemap <url></code>	Analyse or generate an XML sitemap

OFF-SITE & RESEARCH (NEED DATAFORSEO)

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/seo backlinks <url></code>	Backlink profile (needs a Backlinks subscription)
<code>/seo cluster <keyword></code>	Group keywords into content clusters
<code>/seo local <url></code>	Local SEO signals on the website
<code>/seo maps <business></code>	Map-pack rankings, GBP audit, reviews
<code>/seo sxo <url></code>	Why a page does/doesn't rank for its intent
<code>/seo drift baseline compare <url></code>	Track SEO changes over time

PLANNING & CREATION

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>/seo plan <type></code>	Strategic SEO plan (saas, local, ecommerce, etc.)
<code>/seo content-brief <topic></code>	A competitive content brief for a writer
<code>/seo competitor-pages</code>	Build "X vs Y" / alternatives pages

Don't memorise these. In practice you run `/seo audit` for the big picture, then use a focused command to drill into whatever the audit flagged.

8. The flagship: a full site audit

This is the command you'll use most. Typing `/seo audit https://yourclient.com` runs a four-phase pipeline. You don't drive it — but knowing the phases helps you read the result.

Phase 0 — Understand the business (first, always)

Before looking for problems, the system reads the site to figure out **what the business actually is**: its model (B2B, e-commerce, local, etc.), country of origin, likely target markets, ideal customers, and the keyword themes that matter. This shapes everything after it — there's no point researching keywords for the wrong country. You'll see this summarised at the top of the report as "Business Understanding".

Phase 1 — The audit itself

Specialist agents examine the site in parallel across: technical, content/E-E-A-T, schema, Core Web Vitals (real speed data), AI-search readiness, and search-experience. Each finding is checked against the evidence; high-severity findings are double-checked before they make the report.

Phase 2 — Keyword research

Using the business understanding, it runs a full keyword-research pass across the home market and detected target markets (section 9).

Phase 3 — Local SEO & Google Business Profile

If the business is local (has premises or a service area), it audits the Google Business Profile and local signals (section 10). If it's purely online, this phase is skipped and the report says so.

What to expect when you run it

- 1 You type `/seo audit https://yourclient.com` .
- 2 The system fetches the site's pages, builds the business profile, and fans out its specialists. This takes a few minutes — longer for big sites.
- 3 You get a written summary in the chat, and full report files saved to disk (an action plan, a keyword report, and — on request — a polished PDF).

Tip: if it's a big site, the system honours sensible crawl limits and tells you what it covered. If something couldn't be fetched, it says so rather than guessing.

Cost awareness. The keyword and local phases use DataForSEO credits (typically well under a few dollars for one audit). The system can show a cost plan before spending — just ask it to preview costs if you want to see them first.

9. Keyword research, explained

The keyword research is built to be **decision-ready**, not a raw dump. It researches your seed themes across the home market plus any target markets the system detected, and returns a table with the numbers you need to prioritise.

The metrics you'll see

COLUMN	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Global / Country volume	How many people search this per month (worldwide, and per market)
CPC	What advertisers pay per click — a proxy for commercial value
KD (difficulty)	0–100; how hard it is to rank. Lower is easier.
Intent	Why people search it: informational, commercial, transactional, navigational
Current rank	Where the site already ranks (blank = not yet ranking)

Opportunity tiers — where to act first

- **Quick wins** — keywords you already rank for at positions 4–20. Small on-page work moves these onto/up page one. **Highest ROI; start here.**
- **Strategic targets** — high-volume commercial terms you don't yet rank for → new or upgraded pages.
- **Gap captures** — terms a competitor ranks for and you don't.
- **Long-tail / content** — lower-volume, specific terms; great for blog posts and AI-citation answers.

Reading the markets honestly. Sometimes a "target market" turns out to have very little search demand. The report will say so plainly and tell you to focus where the volume actually is, rather than spreading effort thin.

If you see "Data pending — requires DataForSEO". Keyword research needs DataForSEO connected and (if a whitelist is on) your IP approved. See sections 5 and 16.

10. Local SEO & Google Business Profile

For any business with a physical location or service area, this phase audits how it shows up locally. It works on three levels depending on what you've connected:

TIER	NEEDS	WHAT YOU GET
A — First-party	Business Profile connected (owner access)	Real impressions, calls, direction requests, posts — the deepest view
B — Public	DataForSEO connected	Map-pack rankings, GBP completeness, reviews & velocity, competitors in radius
0 — On-page only	Nothing extra	Local signals on the website itself (NAP, local schema, location pages)

The report always states which tier it used, so you know what's covered and what would deepen it.

What it checks

- **NAP consistency** — is the Name, Address, Phone identical across the site, Google, and directories? Mismatches hurt local ranking.
- **Reviews** — rating, count, how steadily new reviews arrive (velocity), and owner responses.
- **Profile completeness** — categories, hours, photos, attributes.
- **Local schema** — is the website marked up as a LocalBusiness with location and hours?

Real example from a live audit: a client's address had a stray trailing dash ("Dubai -") in both the website code *and* the Google profile — a single bad master record polluting everything. The local audit catches exactly this kind of cross-source inconsistency.

11. Single-purpose analyses

When the full audit flags something, drill in with a focused command. They produce the same evidence-backed quality, scoped to one area.

YOU WANT TO...	RUN
Check one important page in depth	<code>/seo page <url></code>
Fix structured data / get rich results	<code>/seo schema <url></code> (it can generate the corrected JSON-LD for you)
Improve site speed / Core Web Vitals	<code>/seo technical <url></code>
Strengthen content authority (E-E-A-T)	<code>/seo content <url></code>
Get cited by AI assistants	<code>/seo geo <url></code>
Understand why a page won't rank	<code>/seo sxo <url></code>
Plan content around a topic	<code>/seo cluster <keyword></code> then <code>/seo content-brief <topic></code>
Prove your work to a client over time	<code>/seo drift baseline <url></code> now, <code>/seo drift compare <url></code> later

The drift tool is your friend for retainers. Take a "baseline" snapshot today; weeks later, "compare" shows exactly what changed on the site — turning vague check-ins into concrete, evidenced updates.

12. Reading your reports

Reports are written to files on your computer (Markdown for editing, and a polished PDF on request). Here's how to read them with confidence.

The health score

A 0–100 composite. Importantly, the system **only scores what it can verify**. If backlinks aren't connected, that category shows "Pending" and is excluded from the score — and the report says so. A score is never padded with guesses.

Severity labels

LABEL	MEANING	ACT WITHIN
Critical	Blocks indexing or causes penalties	Immediately
High	Significantly affects rankings	~1 week
Medium	Worthwhile optimisation	~1 month
Low	Nice to have	Backlog

Every finding shows its evidence

Findings cite where they came from — a file and line in the site's code, or a specific data field. This is what lets you (or a developer) verify and fix each item, and what lets you defend the report to a client.

"Data pending" sections

These aren't failures — they're an honest statement that a data source isn't connected yet. The report tells you exactly what to connect to fill them in.

The action plan

Findings are turned into a prioritised plan: each item has an effort estimate and the reason it matters, ordered so dependencies come first (e.g. fix the server speed before chasing layout-shift ghosts). Work it top-down.

13. A suggested weekly routine

A simple rhythm that turns the system into a repeatable service:

- 1 Monday — full audit per client.** `/seo audit` on each site. Skim the score and the top-5 priorities.
- 2 Act on quick wins.** From the keyword report, take the "quick win" keywords (already ranking 4–20) and improve the matching pages first — best effort-to-result ratio.
- 3 Track change.** Keep a `/seo drift baseline` per site; `compare` weekly so client updates are concrete.
- 4 Re-measure at ~28 days.** Rankings and Core Web Vitals are trailing windows — wait about a month after changes to fairly judge impact, then re-audit.

For a new prospect, run one audit live on the discovery call. A real score and three evidenced priorities win engagements faster than a promise to "take a look".

14. Where your keys live (security)

You're handling client and account credentials, so it's worth knowing exactly how they're treated.

- **Stored on your machine only**, in a protected folder: `~/.config/claude-seo/` (on Windows, under your user profile). Keys are saved with owner-only permissions.
- **Never in the project files**, never uploaded anywhere. The only places a key travels are to that provider's own service when the system calls it.
- **Never shown in chat**. The wizard hides key entry; the system is instructed never to print a key back.
- **No tracking**. The system doesn't phone home or send analytics.

Good habits

- If you ever paste a key into the chat by mistake, regenerate it from the provider.
- To remove a provider, delete its file in `~/.config/claude-seo/`.
- Run `/seo-setup verify` occasionally — it flags if any stored key has loose file permissions.

In short: your credentials stay on your computer, owner-only, and are used solely to call the services you connected. This is by design and is documented in the project's `SECURITY.md`.

15. Keeping the system up to date

Claude SEO Pro is built on an open-source SEO toolkit that improves over time. The Pro layer (your onboarding, the smarter audit pipeline, the no-fabrication rules) sits on top and is preserved across updates.

You don't need to do anything manually — if your team has enabled it, updates arrive as a **reviewed pull request** roughly weekly, pulling in upstream improvements while keeping all the Pro features intact. Whoever maintains the repository approves these.

As a day-to-day user, the practical takeaway is: the system stays current on its own, and updates never silently change your connected APIs or your reports' integrity rules.

16. Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	CAUSE & FIX
Data calls fail with <code>40207</code>	DataForSEO IP whitelist. Your computer's IP isn't approved. Add it (or turn the whitelist off) at <code>app.dataforseo.com/api-access</code> . On home/mobile internet your IP changes, so turning the whitelist off is usually best. To see your current IP, ask Claude or run <code>! curl -s https://api.ipify.org</code> .
Backlinks section says <code>40204</code> / "subscription required"	Your DataForSEO plan doesn't include the Backlinks API . Activate it at <code>app.dataforseo.com/backlinks-subscription</code> , or connect free Moz / Bing Webmaster credentials. The audit deliberately leaves this empty rather than estimate it.
A data command says the connector "isn't available"	Either the provider isn't connected (run <code>/seo-setup verify</code>) or Claude Code wasn't restarted after connecting it. Restart Claude Code — connectors load at startup.
DataForSEO / Firecrawl / Exa won't load at all	Node.js missing. These connectors need it. Install Node from <code>nodejs.org</code> , then restart.
Keyword research shows nothing for a market	Some markets/languages aren't supported by the keyword-ideas engine (you'll see a note), or the market genuinely has low demand. The report uses the best available data and says which.
Google Search Console / GBP sign-in didn't finish	The one-time browser sign-in needs to complete. Re-run the auth command the wizard gave you, and make sure the Google account has access to the property/listing.
A report section says "Data pending"	Working as intended — that data source isn't connected. The section names exactly what to connect.
An audit couldn't read some pages	The site may block automated requests, or pages may be down. The report lists what it couldn't fetch and never fills the gap with guesses.

17. FAQ

DO I NEED TO KNOW HOW TO CODE?

No. You type commands and read reports. The only "commands" are the copy-paste lines in this manual.

WILL IT EVER MAKE UP DATA TO FILL A REPORT?

No — that's its core design rule. Missing data shows as "Data pending" with instructions, never as an invented number.

HOW MUCH DO THE APIS COST?

The on-site audit is free. DataForSEO charges small per-call amounts; a full audit's keyword + local research is typically well under a few dollars. You can preview costs before running.

CAN I RUN IT ON ANY WEBSITE?

Yes — you don't need to own the site for on-site analysis, rankings, keyword research, or public local data. Only the first-party Google Search Console / GA4 / Business Profile data requires access to that account.

WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN `/SEO LOCAL` AND `/SEO MAPS` ?

`/seo local` checks local signals on the *website*; `/seo maps` checks the business on map *platforms* (Google Maps rankings, GBP, reviews). The full audit uses both where relevant.

HOW OFTEN SHOULD I RE-AUDIT?

Weekly for active clients is ideal; always wait ~28 days after changes before judging ranking/speed impact, since those metrics are trailing.

18. Glossary

TERM	PLAIN MEANING
On-site / Off-site	Data read from the website itself / data from external services (rankings, volumes, backlinks)
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust — Google's content-quality signals
Core Web Vitals (CWV)	Google's page-experience speed metrics: LCP (load), INP (responsiveness), CLS (visual stability)
Field data (CrUX)	Speed measured from real visitors — what Google actually ranks on (vs lab estimates)
Schema / structured data	Hidden labels in a page's code that help search engines understand it (powers rich results)
GEO	Optimising to be cited by AI search (AI Overviews, ChatGPT, Perplexity)
GBP	Google Business Profile — the business's Google Maps/Search listing
NAP	Name, Address, Phone — must be consistent everywhere for local SEO
KD	Keyword Difficulty (0–100) — how hard a keyword is to rank for
CPC	Cost Per Click — advertiser price; a proxy for commercial value
Intent	Why someone searches: informational, commercial, transactional, navigational
Quick win	A keyword you already rank 4–20 for — cheap to push onto page one
Agent / specialist	A behind-the-scenes worker the system dispatches for one area of an audit
Data pending	An honest placeholder: this needs a data source you haven't connected yet

19. Command cheat-sheet

```
# --- setup ---
/seo-setup                # connect your APIs (guided)
/seo-setup verify         # what's connected / pending
! python ~/.claude/skills/seo/onboarding/setup_wizard.py --check

# --- the big one ---
/seo audit https://example.com    # full 4-phase audit

# --- focused checks ---
/seo page https://example.com/about
/seo technical https://example.com
/seo content https://example.com
/seo schema https://example.com
/seo geo https://example.com
/seo images https://example.com
/seo sitemap https://example.com

# --- off-site & research (need DataForSEO) ---
/seo backlinks https://example.com
/seo cluster "exhibition stand contractor"
/seo local https://example.com
/seo maps "Business Name Dubai"
/seo sxo https://example.com

# --- track & plan ---
/seo drift baseline https://example.com    # snapshot now
/seo drift compare  https://example.com    # what changed
/seo plan local
/seo content-brief "exhibition stand design dubai"
```

Claude SEO Pro — User Manual v01 · For Claude SEO Pro 1.0.0 · Covers operating the system (onboarding, commands, audits, reports).
Installation is in the project README. Your credentials stay on your machine; the system never fabricates data.